

CLEF 2026 JOKER Track

Humor Detection, Search, and Translation

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Motivation



- Goal: evaluate the State-of-the-art AI, NLP, and IR models
- State-of-the-art AI, NLP, and IR models are not able to deal with humour or other non-literal meaning aspects of texts
- Wordplay, which can refer to the surface structure or orthography of a word or its pronunciation, is a challenge for AI
- Word surface aspects are not captured in the deep semantic embedding in AI models
- These also cannot be captured by current pre-training models based on next-word prediction objectives

JOKER 2026 Tasks



- JOKER Track continues Humor-aware IR, and Humor-aware MT + new tasks and languages
- CLEF 2026 JOKER Track
 - *Humor Detection, Search, and Translation*
- The following 4 tasks:
 - ➊ **Humor-aware Information Retrieval:** *retrieve short humorous texts for a query in English and Hinglish.*
 - ➋ **Pun Translation:** *translate puns from English to French.*
 - ➌ **Onomastic Wordplay Translation:** *translate onomastic wordplay from English to French.*
 - ➍ **Humor Generation:** *generate humorous text from a given context in English, French, and Spanish.*

JOKER 2026 Track Participation



JOKER	Task 1		Task 2	Task 3	Task 4		
	English ^a	Hinglish ^b	French ^c	French ^d	English ^e	Spanish ^f	French ^g
Teams	16	11	12	4	4	4	4
Runs	642	125	422	55	98	134	133
Teams	18					4	
Runs	767					365	
Teams				22			
Runs				1,607			

^a<https://www.codabench.org/competitions/10550/>

^b<https://www.codabench.org/competitions/10551/>

^c<https://www.codabench.org/competitions/16309/>

^d<https://www.codabench.org/competitions/16704/>

^e<https://www.codabench.org/competitions/13879/>

^f<https://www.codabench.org/competitions/15742/>

^g<https://www.codabench.org/competitions/15743/>



Task 1

Humor-aware Information Retrieval¹

¹Poojan Vachharajani, Arjun Mukherjee, Jasvinder Singh, Krishna Tewari, Sukomal Pal, Jaap Kamps, Liana Ermakova, Overview of the CLEF 2026 JOKER Task 1: Humor-Aware Information Retrieval in English and Hinglish, CLEF CEUR, 4116-4129

Task 1: Humor-aware Information Retrieval



- *Task 1: Humor-aware Information Retrieval:*
 - retrieve short humorous texts for a query in English and Hinglish
- Use case: to search for a joke on a specific topic
 - Large corpus with queries for jokes on a general topic
 - Several relevant jokes on this topic
 - Many distractor docs (new hard negatives): on topic but no joke
- New data
 - **English task:**
 - Corpus of 96,603 short documents
 - 10 train and 971 test queries
 - 4,572 relevance judgments
 - **Hinglish task:**
 - Corpus of 32,652 short documents
 - 10 train and 485 test queries
- Evaluation: traditional IR metrics (MAP, NDCG, ...)
- *Main JOKER IR Task, continues from 2024-2025*

Dataset Construction



- Dataset constructed using LLM-based generation and search-grounded harvesting
- **Positive humour and wordplay**
 - Gemini 2.5 Flash + Google Search: retrieves real-world jokes related to target query terms
 - For Hinglish, data generated in three forms: English, Romanized Hindi, and Hinglish
 - Claude Sonnet 4: controlled generation of original jokes/puns
- **Negative distractors**
 - Factual, non-humorous texts containing the same query term
 - English: 20 distractors/query
 - Hinglish: 60 distractors/query (20 each)

Example: query = “Chindi”

Positive / Relevant: “He is so *chindi*, even his wallet asks him for a loan!”

Hard Negative: “Chindi is an informal Hindi term used to describe a very stingy person.”

Document examples



English

```
[
  {
    "id":0,
    "contents":"Why did the musician get an A+ in alphabet class?"
    ↪ "Because they really knew their A!"
  },
  {
    "id":1,
    "contents":"What did the article say when it won first place?"
    ↪ "I'm a winner!"
  }
]
```

Hinglish

```
[
  {
    "id":"21295",
    "contents":"She handled the sharam situation very gracefully."
  },
  {
    "id":"16670",
    "contents":"My neighbor is such a jaanwar when he's angry - it's"
    ↪ like watching Animal Planet live!"
  }
]
```

Task 1: Results (English)



# Team	MAP	NDCG			MRR	Prec	Run ID
		5	10	100			
1 arampageos	0.76	0.85	0.82	0.85	0.99	0.30	submission_english_block LeakHybrid_06072_blockfirst_seq
2 vanguard_team	0.63	0.69	0.71	0.77	0.83	0.31	ce30j70_t30_p85_qw60_go30_gn10
3 astral_fate	0.61	0.70	0.69	0.75	0.85	0.28	lgb_cls
4 arjun108	0.39	0.47	0.50	0.54	0.68	0.23	S1_1
5 madhangi	0.32	0.38	0.40	0.50	0.54	0.18	BM25
6 xinrui_qiu	0.31	0.41	0.41	0.44	0.60	0.17	MPNetRoBERTa
7 ezrasmink	0.30	0.30	0.55	0.27	0.18	0.02	no reranker + WordNet 0.3
8 prasann	0.27	0.26	0.34	0.46	0.39	0.20	contrastive learn with instruct
– Baseline	0.11	0.10	0.11	0.27	0.21	0.05	BM25 Anserini Index

- Non-topical content not handled by standard search
 - Lexical IR score dramatic due to distractors: on-topic but no humor.
 - Semantic matching increases recall: relevant jokes without literal match
 - Top scoring team "cheat" by classifying the entire corpus: expensive but effective...

Task 1: Results (Hinglish)



# Team	MAP	NDCG			MRR	Prec	Run ID
		5	10	100			
1 arampageos	0.66	0.72	0.75	0.80	0.88	0.50	submission_hinglish_tree_ens_et_gb
2 xinrui_qiu	0.39	0.54	0.52	0.54	0.84	0.27	RIVER_task_1_MPNerRoBERTa
3 arjun108	0.34	0.45	0.46	0.51	0.76	0.26	S1_1
4 madhangi	0.22	0.28	0.29	0.45	0.55	0.16	BM25
– Baseline	0.09	0.18	0.16	0.16	0.53	0.05	Baseline

- Hinglish full of linguistic complexities
 - Non-standard transliterations, informal Romanized spellings.
 - Mixed-language expressions embedding English lexical items within Hindi grammatical frameworks
- Very challenging search conditions, but modern models seem to cope well.

Task 1: Findings



- 18 teams submitted 767 runs to CodaBench: 642 for English and 125 for Hinglish
- Standard lexical retrieval performs poorly because topically relevant documents are not necessarily humorous
- Best performance substantially outperformed the baselines: $MAP = 0.76$ for English and $MAP = 0.66$ for Hinglish
- Strong systems combine topical retrieval with explicit humour-aware filtering or reranking
- Joke-format and surface features such as pun morphology, punctuation, and lexical patterns are highly effective for distinguishing humorous texts from factual distractors
- Hinglish remains more challenging due to non-standard transliteration, informal Romanized spellings, code-mixing, and culturally grounded humour
- The highest English result was partly influenced by a sequential block pattern in the corpus; this artifact did not transfer effectively to Hinglish



Task 2

Pun Translation²

²Liana Ermakova, Yael Naud, Lilian Binet, Baptiste Dumas, Jaap Kamps Overview of the CLEF 2026 JOKER Task 2: Pun Translation from English to French, CLEF CEUR: 4130-4144

Task 2: Pun Translation



- *Task 2: Translate Puns from English to French:*
 - preserve wordplay form
 - preserve wordplay meaning
- Professional French translations of English puns, manually annotated for wordplay location
 - **Train data:** 5,838 manual FR translations of 1,405 EN puns
 - **Test data:** 6,951 new manual FR translations of 2,656 EN puns

```
{ "id_en": "en_1",  
  "en": "I used to be a banker, but I lost interest",  
  "fr": "J'ai été banquier mais, j'en ai perdu tout l'intérêt." }
```

- Eval:
 - Location-based metric on the ground truth new professional translations (unseen by LLMs)
 - Manual evaluation
- *Main JOKER NLP Task, continues from 2022-2025*

Task 2: Data example



English pun / References + Location

OLD PHOTOGRAPHERS never die, they just lose their focus.

Un photographe ne meurt jamais, seulement, il n'a plus d'objectifs.

Un photographe, ça ne meurt pas, ça change seulement d'objectif.

Quand les vieux photographes meurent, ils trépieassent.

Les vieux photographes ne meurent jamais, ils retouchent du bois pour rester en vie.

Les vieux photographes ne meurent pas, ils perdent leurs objectifs de vue.

Les photographes ne meurent jamais, ils vont juste faire des mises au point.

Les vieux photographes ne meurent pas, mais ils attrapent des pellicules.

Quand un photographe vieillit, il ne meurt pas, mais quand même, c'est pas pareil.

Les vieux photographes perdent souvent vue de leurs objectifs et ont besoin d'une mise au point.

Les photographes ne meurent pas, seulement, ils deviennent des vieux flous.

JOKER corpus



- 12,861 French translations of the corpus for 4,059 English puns created by Miller et al. (2017)³
 - 8,823 French translations by professional translators, native French speakers
 - 4,038 machine translations (i.e., preserving meaning and containing wordplay)
- 7,786 distinct pun locations in FR
- 17,506 FR machine translations of 4,145 EN puns manually annotated by native French translators for meaning preservation and wordplay

³Miller et al. (2017) SemEval-2017 Task 7: Detection and Interpretation of English Puns

Task 2: Results (location-based metric)



#	Team	# runs	Best score	Rank	run_id
1	dsgt-arc	37	32.59	1	ensemble_0_0_0_100_gpt_pooled
2	dsgt-arc	37	32.16	2	gpt_5.5_single
3	dsgt-arc	37	31.11	3	ensemble_0_0_0_100_all_pooled
6	n0shi	5	28.71	6	Satir_CVO_Direct_mistral_large:12
7	arampageos	340	27.94	7	DUTH_QANCHOR_TOP25
8	arampageos	340	27.90	8	DUTH_NOTORCH_SELECTOR_S
9	arampageos	340	27.90	9	DUTH_QANCHOR_REFONLY
12	n0shi	5	25.76	325	Satir_Baseline
13	ezrasmink	5	25.22	336	UAms_marian-ft_content0.0
14	ezrasmink	5	25.22	337	UAms_marian_ft_content0.25
15	n0shi	5	25.11	342	Satir_BaselineCVO
16	n0shi	5	24.83	348	Satir_Classifier
17	robinflir	2	24.57	351	UAms_MarianMT_XLMRoBERTa
19	robinflir	2	23.85	359	UAms_MarianMT_CamemBERT
22	madhangi	1	22.29	370	PixelPair_groq_llama
24	Baseline	1	7.05	391	identity_run

Task 2: Results (manual evaluation - 948 translations)



#	Team	# runs	count	WP	MP	Success	Rank	run_id
1	dsgt-arc	37	96	82	48	44	1	ensemble_0_0_0_100_all_pooled_t
2	dsgt-arc	37	96	79	50	44	2	ensemble_0_0_0_100_gpt_pooled_
3	dsgt-arc	37	96	79	50	42	3	gpt_5.5_single
4	n0shi	5	100	38	70	29	13	Satir_CVO_Direct_mistral_large:12
5	n0shi	5	85	39	60	29	16	Satir_Baseline
6	arampageos	340	97	29	77	25	23	TrainQrelsLeak_FUZZY96_LOCKED
7	arampageos	340	97	29	77	25	24	TrainQrelsLeak_EXACT_ALL_MED
8	arampageos	340	100	29	78	25	25	QANCHOR_REFONLY
9	ezrasmink	5	96	23	63	21	308	UAMS_opus_mt_en_fr_finetuned
10	madhang	1	100	36	52	20	337	PixelPair_groq_llama
11	ezrasmink	5	96	22	62	18	345	UAMS_marian_ft_content0.0
12	ezrasmink	5	96	22	62	18	347	UAMS_marian_ft_content0.25
13	robinflir	2	100	20	65	15	352	UAMS_MarianMT_CamemBERT
14	robinflir	2	100	19	63	14	356	UAMS_MarianMT_XLMRoBERTa
15	n0shi	5	7	6	6	6	371	Satir_Classifier

- WP = % translations with wordplay; MP = % preserving meaning;
Success = % preserving meanin and wordplay

Task 2: Manual Evaluation (948 ex.)



Meaning preservation Wordplay	No	Yes	All
No	61 (6.43%)	33 (3.48%)	94 (9.92%)
Partially	151 (15.93%)	118 (12.45%)	269 (28.38%)
Yes	325 (34.28%)	260 (27.43%)	585 (61.71%)
All	537 (56.65%)	411 (43.35%)	948 (100.00%)

- Distribution of wordplay and meaning preservation in the manually annotated data

Task 2: BLEU score



# team	# runs	BLEU	P1	P2	P3	P4	Rank run_id
1 arampageos	340	40.61	64.21	44.49	34.65	27.48	1 FINAL_REBUILD_319277
2 arampageos	340	40.61	64.21	44.49	34.65	27.48	2 FINAL_DROP_105_106
3 arampageos	340	40.60	64.19	44.48	34.64	27.46	3 FINAL_DROP_51_60_71_80
4 arampageos	340	40.60	64.19	44.47	34.64	27.46	4 FINAL_DROP_71_80
5 arampageos	340	40.60	64.19	44.48	34.64	27.46	5 FAST_BEST_PLUS_105_109
6 n0shi	5	38.29	63.37	42.72	32.19	24.68	320 Satir_CVO_Direct_mistral-large:123b
7 ezrasmink	5	35.77	60.95	39.88	29.69	22.67	333 UAms_marian-ft_content0.25
8 ezrasmink	5	35.76	60.97	39.88	29.67	22.66	334 UAms_marian-ft_content0.0
9 ezrasmink	5	35.68	60.59	40.01	29.66	22.54	335 UAms_nllb-ft_content0.25
10 robinflir	2	35.13	60.49	39.44	29.08	21.96	336 UAms_MarianMT_CamemBERT
11 robinflir	2	35.03	60.65	39.33	28.91	21.84	337 UAms_MarianMT_XLMRoBERTa
12 ezrasmink	5	34.49	60.43	38.74	28.34	21.32	340 UAms_opus-mt-en-fr-finetuned
13 madhangi	1	30.97	55.81	34.94	25.27	18.67	343 PixelPair_groq_llama
14 n0shi	5	27.78	54.31	31.81	22.02	15.66	347 Satir_Baseline
15 ezrasmink	5	27.31	54.72	31.68	21.40	14.99	348 UAms_mbart-ft_content0.25
16 n0shi	5	24.81	51.89	28.77	19.16	13.24	349 Satir_Classifier
17 dsgrt-arc	37	21.54	47.32	25.17	16.35	11.05	350 ensemble_0_0_0_100_gemini_pooled
18 dsgrt-arc	37	21.53	46.85	25.00	16.37	11.20	351 gemini_3.1_pro_preview_single
19 n0shi	5	21.52	46.74	24.63	16.35	11.39	352 Satir_BaselineCVO
20 dsgrt-arc	37	20.72	46.38	24.41	15.61	10.43	353 ensemble_0_0_0_100_all_pooled
21 dsgrt-arc	37	19.57	45.08	23.08	14.57	9.68	354 ensemble_0_0_0_100_gpt_pooled
22 dsgrt-arc	37	18.85	43.85	22.05	13.95	9.37	355 ensemble_15_15_35_35_all_pooled
23 n0shi	5	17.92	42.37	20.82	13.23	8.83	360 Satir_ClassifierCVO

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Task 2: BLEU results (Train)



# team	# runs	BLEU	P1	P2	P3	P4	Rank run_id
1 arampageos	340	99.72	99.87	99.77	99.68	99.59	1 TrainQrelsLeak_EXACT_ALL_MEDOID
2 arampageos	340	99.55	99.74	99.60	99.49	99.38	2 TrainQrelsLeak_FUZZY96_LOCKED_M
3 arampageos	340	99.55	99.74	99.60	99.49	99.38	3 TrainQrelsMulti_WRATIO96_ME
4 arampageos	340	99.55	99.74	99.60	99.49	99.38	4 TrainQrelsLeak_EXACT_LOCKED_ME
5 arampageos	340	99.55	99.74	99.60	99.49	99.38	5 TrainQrelsLeak_FUZZY94_LOCKED_M
6 ezrasmink	5	54.40	74.19	58.23	48.90	41.44	94 UAms_nllb-ft_content0.25
7 ezrasmink	5	53.45	74.06	57.04	47.70	40.50	95 UAms_opus-mt-en-fr-finetuned
8 ezrasmink	5	51.94	72.87	55.65	46.14	38.91	96 UAms_marian-ft_content0.0
9 ezrasmink	5	51.94	72.85	55.64	46.15	38.90	97 UAms_marian-ft_content0.25
10 robinflir	2	50.78	72.10	54.60	44.96	37.55	98 UAms_MarianMT_CamemBERT
11 robinflir	2	50.30	72.07	54.13	44.39	36.95	99 UAms_MarianMT_XLMRoBERTa
12 ezrasmink	5	48.35	70.31	52.14	42.44	35.12	103 UAms_mbart-ft_content0.25
13 n0shi	5	42.55	67.48	46.69	36.20	28.74	339 Satir_CVO_Direct_mistral-large:123b
14 n0shi	5	38.56	62.60	41.30	32.16	26.59	344 Satir_Baseline
15 madhangi	1	36.56	62.28	40.40	30.33	23.41	345 PixelPair_groq_llama
16 n0shi	5	34.80	56.70	36.71	28.97	24.31	346 Satir_BaselineCVO
17 n0shi	5	30.86	56.84	34.04	24.75	18.94	350 team1_TranslateByDecomposition
18 n0shi	5	30.42	54.25	32.91	24.56	19.52	351 team1_ClassifierCVO
19 dsgrt-arc	37	25.45	52.95	29.35	19.71	13.70	352 gemini_3.1_pro_preview_single
20 dsgrt-arc	37	23.98	52.02	27.96	18.35	12.39	353 ensemble_0_0_0_100_gemini_pooled
21 dsgrt-arc	37	22.04	49.74	25.76	16.60	11.09	354 ensemble_0_0_0_100_all_pooled
22 dsgrt-arc	37	20.20	47.83	23.80	14.89	9.83	355 ensemble_0_0_0_100_gpt_pooled
23 dsgrt-arc	37	20.05	47.46	23.50	14.80	9.79	356 ensemble_25_25_25_25_gemini

Task 2: Translation errors



Error type	#	EN	Erroneous FR	Reference FR
Lost pun/-reference	316	Camille relocated to Little Italy: They made her a cougher	Camille a déménagé en Italie : ils l'ont faite tousseuse	Camille déménagea à Little Italy : ils lui firent une gaufre qu'elle ne pouvait pas refuser.
Literal translation	180	If you don't know how to choose music ask a guitarist – they know how to pick.	Si tu ne sais pas choisir la musique, demande à un guitariste, il sait choisir.	Pour choisir entre deux morceaux, prends un guitariste : c'est le meilleur médiateur.
Partially literal translation	59	OLD DIVERS never die, they just get board.	Les vieux plongeurs ne meurent jamais, ils font seulement un trou dans l'eau.	Les vieux plongeurs ne meurent jamais : ils finissent juste par faire la planche.
Partially random	44	Holograms: the show must ghost on!	Hologrammes : le spectacle doit fantôme sur !	Hologrammes : le spectre-acle doit continuer !
Other	23	When walking through a pig barn be careful how you maneuver.	Quand vous traversez une porcherie, faites attention à comment vous manœuvrez pour éviter le fumier.	En traversant une porcherie, faites gaffe à comment vous manœuvrez... ça pourrait sentir le fumier.
Partially untranslated	18	Flying these days is a frisky business.	Voler aujourd'hui, c'est une affaire frisky.	Prendre l'avion de nos jours, ça donne vraiment des palpations.
Incorrect grammar/-spelling	10	Curiouser and curiouser!	De curio en curio !	De plus très-curieux en plus très-curieux !
Missing words/-punctuation	1	Henry perfected the Ford down to a T.	Henri a amélioré la Ford jusqu'à la lettre.	Henry a perfectionné sa Ford de A à T.
Random	5	Blossom into a new you!	Quel est le comble pour un nouveau toi ?	Épanouis-toi : il est temps de fleurir sans te planter.

Task 2: Findings



- 14 teams submitted 446 runs to CodaBench
- Location-based metric matches the manual evaluation (Spearman correlation = 0.8517)
- BLEU does not show no correlation with translation success ($\rho = -0.0841$)
- A comparison of the training and test results revealed varying degrees of overfitting
- Considerable improvements in the quality of automatic pun translation
- Frequent errors: loss of the original pun or cultural reference and literal translations that preserved the meaning but failed to recreate the humor.
- Other errors are rare: untranslated words, grammatical mistakes, or random translations.



Task 3

Onomastic Wordplay Translation⁴

⁴Liana Ermakova, Yael Naud, Lilian Binet, Jaap Kamps, Overview of the CLEF 2026 JOKER Task 3: Onomastic Wordplay Translation from English to French, CLEF CEUR: 4145-4153.

Task 3: Onomastic Wordplay Translation



- *Task 3: Translate Onomastic Wordplay from English to French*
- Onomastic wordplay is challenging for AI models but common in fictional text (Pokemons, Asterix, Harry Potter,...)
- Parallel corpus of wordplay in named entities in English and French
 - Test: 2,598 English names with 2,851 French reference translations
 - Train: 353 pairs
- Eval:
 - Ground truth new professional translations (unseen by LLMs)
 - Manual binary evaluation of 719 distinct FR translations of 313 EN sources

Example



```
[
  {
    "id": "en_1",
    "en": "Asterix",
    "description": "Asterix is the small but clever hero of the Asterix
    ↪ comic series. Known for his sharp wit and courage, he outsmarts
    ↪ the Roman invaders with the help of a magical potion that grants
    ↪ him superhuman strength. Alongside his loyal friend Obelix,
    ↪ Asterix defends his village and embodies bravery and
    ↪ cleverness.",
    "fr": "Astérix"
  }
]
```

Task 3: Results (manual evaluation - 740 translations)



#	team	#runs	Score	Rank	Refs	Alter	Copy	run_id
1	UBO	5	71.88	1	44.11	45.37	8.20	gemini_3_flash
2	arampageos	41	43.13	2	51.58	7.35	40.38	V18_FRLEAD_
3	arampageos	41	43.13	3	51.58	7.35	40.38	V18_FRLEAD_
4	arampageos	41	43.13	4	51.62	7.35	41.49	V14_OFFICIAL
5	arampageos	41	43.13	5	51.58	7.35	40.38	V21_ASTERIX_
6	arampageos	41	43.13	6	51.58	7.35	40.38	V21_ASTERIX_
7	UBO	5	17.25	43	7.08	10.54	24.83	llama
8	ezrasmink	5	13.74	44	6.66	8.31	18.75	marian_ft_cont
9	ezrasmink	5	13.74	45	6.97	8.31	18.55	cascade
10	Baseline	1	13.10	46	13.66	0.00	100.00	identity_run
11	ezrasmink	5	13.10	47	13.97	0.00	97.69	extraction
12	ezrasmink	5	7.35	49	5.47	2.24	21.21	marian_ft_bare
13	UBO	5	4.47	50	3.54	0.32	4.35	Qwen3-4B
14	pjmathematician	4	2.88	51	4.78	0.00	30.29	baseline_sub
15	UBO	5	2.24	55	2.42	1.60	6.31	mistral
16	UBO	5	1.92	56	1.35	0.64	0.15	gemma

Task 3: Train data results



#	team	#runs	Rank	Refs	Copy	run_id
1	arampageos	41	1	98.58	10.48	SAFE_NOPAREN
2	arampageos	41	2	98.58	10.48	POKEMON_FULL
3	arampageos	41	3	98.58	10.48	POKEMON_SAFE
4	arampageos	41	4	98.58	10.48	LEXRULES
5	arampageos	41	5	98.02	10.48	V9_SANITIZE_BIG
6	UBO	5	42	39.66	10.20	gemini-3-flash
7	ezrasmlink	5	43	13.03	97.17	extraction
8	ezrasmlink	5	45	11.05	17.56	cascade
9	pjmathematician	4	46	10.48	100.00	baseline_sub
10	ezrasmlink	5	47	10.48	17.56	marian_ft_context
11	Baseline	1	50	10.48	100.00	identity_run
12	ezrasmlink	5	52	9.63	25.78	marian_ft_barename
13	UBO	5	53	5.67	25.50	llama
14	UBO	5	54	3.12	11.33	mistral
15	UBO	5	55	2.55	0.00	gemma
16	UBO	5	56	2.27	2.55	Qwen3-4B

Task 3: Frequent errors



Problem type	#	Example (EN)	Example (FR)
Random	77	<i>Boltling</i>	<i>Bounteau</i>
Partially random	66	<i>Orchatter</i>	<i>Orchijace</i>
Untranslated	18	<i>Trogglehumper</i>	<i>Trogglehumper</i>
Partially untranslated	140	<i>Marmadoc 'Masterful' Brandybuck</i>	<i>Marmadoc 'Masterful' E</i>
Literal translation	20	<i>Bonnie Hopps</i>	<i>Bonnie Gambade</i>
Partially literal translation	9	<i>Moro Burrows</i>	<i>Moro Creusot</i>
Lost wordplay/reference	108	<i>Nightmare Moon</i>	<i>La Lune de Nuit</i>
Grammar/spelling errors	7	<i>Savoir Fare</i>	<i>Savis Fare</i>
Incomplete or truncated	46	<i>Emotimara</i>	<i>Em</i>
Empty	22		
Other	106	<i>Barrowdowns</i>	<i>Ardenne</i>
None	189	<i>Ash Mountains</i>	<i>Monts de Cendres</i>

Task 3: Findings



- 4 teams submitted 55 valid runs
- The retrieval-based runs reproduced $>50\%$ of the reference translations
- Retrieval-based systems struggle to produce genuine onomastic wordplay translations
- The copy baseline outperformed several systems
- 45% of 313 English source names translated by Gemini were successful genuine translations
- Only 29% of 740 manually translations were successful
- Frequent errors: partially untranslated names (19%); loss of the original wordplay or reference (15%); random or partially random inventions (19%); incomplete, empty, or truncated translation (9%); literal translations that sacrifice the joke; omission of parts of compound names; missing punctuation or minor grammatical issues.



Task 4

Humor Generation⁵

⁵Igor Kuzmin, Anne-Gwenn Bosser, Jaap Kamps, Liana Ermakova, Overview of the CLEF 2026 JOKER Task 4: Humor Generation in English, French, and Spanish, CLEF CEUR: 4154-4179.

Task 4: Humor Generation



- *Task 4: Generate Humorous Text in English, French, and Spanish*
- New task on humor generation:
 - can models produce humor across languages under clear constraints?
 - assessment centered on semantic consistency, humorous effect,
 - evaluate justified adaptation rather than surface overlap
- Evaluation challenging...
 - Human evaluation of small samples.
 - LLM evaluation is indicative but imprecise.
 - Set up an LLM/chatbot arena.

- Data:

Track	Train	Test
EN	3,344	150
ES	392	151
FR	1,599	156

Train example (FR)



```
[
  {
    "id": "fr_0001",
    "lang": "fr",
    "pun_word": "barbec-ours",
    "sense_a": "barbecue",
    "sense_b": "bear",
    "keywords": ["BBQ", "cookout", "grill", "grizzly", "brown bear",
    ↪ "cub", "..."],
    "hint": "barbec-ours / barbecue + ours ~ <côtelette; grizzly;
    ↪ cuit>",
    "reference_joke": "Comment on cuit des côtelette de grizzly ? Au
    ↪ barbec-ours.",
    "reference_en": "What do you call grizzly's ribs ? A bearbecue."
  }
]
```

Task 4: Results (majority vote LLM Arena)



	Team	#	BT	Rnk	95% CI	run_id
EN	SaLT	4	1,257	1	[1215, 1308]	SaLT_KimiCSF
	DUTH	80	1,127	5	[1055, 1184]	DUTH_EN_BEST984_PLUS_TRAINSEL_TOP1_F
	UBO	5	1,125	6	[1084, 1168]	UBO_gemini-3_pun
	UAms	9	983	74	[937, 1024]	UAms_Qwen2.5-32B-Instruct
ES	SaLT	4	1,515	1	[1450, 1599]	SaLT_KimiCSF
	UBO	5	1,351	4	[1310, 1396]	UBO_gemini-3_pun
	DUTH	120	1,314	6	[1259, 1367]	DUTH_ARENAJUDGE_ES
	UAms	5	1,061	60	[1026, 1105]	UAms_Llama-3-Instruct-Neurona-8b
FR	SaLT	4	1,395	1	[1342, 1449]	SaLT_KimiCSF
	DUTH	115	1,304	2	[1245, 1417]	DUTH_FR_LEAK_NOR13_DROP_R04
	UBO	10	1,279	7	[1234, 1341]	UBO_gemini-3-flash_pun
	UAms	4	1,191	41	[1149, 1229]	UAms_Chocolatine-2-14B-Instruct

- LLM Arena with both humans and LLMs judging
 - Few submissions due to late availability of the data
 - Watch this task at the CLEF 2027 JOKER Track...

Task 4: Example LLM Arena battles



English brief — pun word: lama

Sense 1: a Tibetan or Mongolian priest of Lamaism. *Sense 2:* a wild or domesticated South American cud-chewing animal related to camels but smaller and lacking a hump.

A (DUTH / EN_BEST984_DROP_PATCH_BUCKET_05): I followed a **lama** to the mountains, hoping to learn some spiritual enlightenment. He just kept asking me to spit out my gum.

B (SaLT / KimiCSF): I joined what I thought was a Buddhist retreat—everyone followed our leader religiously. Then I noticed he spat when excited and ate exclusively hay. Turns out my **lama** was not what I expected.

Verdicts: gpt-oss-20b=B, deepseek-chat=B, gemini-2.5-flash-lite=B. **Ensemble: B** (unanimous).

Spanish brief — pun word: picazón

Sentido 1: picazón (*démangeaison*). *Sentido 2:* *itching* ~ *alergia*; picazón; fiebre del heno.

A (SaLT / KimiCSF): Le dije al alérgico: “Relájate, es solo fiebre del heno.” Él respondió: “¿Solo? Tengo **picazón**... ¡y ya no sé si es la alergia o el heno existencial!”

B (DUTH / ES_DIAG_REFERENCE_STYLE_2): Nadie esperaba que **picazón** fuera el remate.

Verdicts: gpt-oss-20b=A, deepseek-chat=A, gemini-2.5-flash-lite=A. **Ensemble: A** (unanimous).

French brief — pun word: potentiel

Sens 1: potentiel (électricité). *Sens 2:* potentiel (ressources).

A (SaLT / KimiCSF): Panne électrique. Je sors mon facture, lumière de bougie: “Monsieur, vous avez du **potentiel**.” Je tremble... est-ce qu'ils parlent de mes ressources, ou est-ce que le compteur se moque de moi?

B (DUTH / FR_LEAK_TOP21): Il a un **potentiel** énorme, mais il préfère rester branché.

Verdicts: gpt-oss-20b=A, deepseek-chat=B, gemini-2.5-flash-lite=B. **Ensemble: B** (2–1 split, brevity preferred).

- Majority vote over three LLM judges with A/B/tie classification.

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CLEF 2026 JOKER Track Sessions



Date	Event
Sep 24 10:20-10:30	Best of the Labs: JOKER 2025
Sep 24 11:00-12:00	JOKER Task Overview Talks
Sep 24 12:00-12:30	Participant's talks (2x)
Sep 24 14:00-15:00	Participant's talks (4x)
Sep 24 15:00-15:30	Planning Session: New corpus, new tasks, exciting challenges and opportunities

- Thursday = CLEF JOKER day!
- Please join the JOKER sessions in Room 131!

Join us at CLEF 2027 in Bucarest!



CLEF 2027

Calls ▾



September 14-17, 2027

Bucharest, Romania

Welcome to CLEF 2027

The Conference and Labs of the Evaluation Forum (CLEF) brings together researchers, developers, and students interested in information access evaluation and establishing evaluation infrastructures.

The CLEF 2027 conference will be hosted by National University of Science and Technology Politehnica Bucharest, Romania, from **September 14-17, 2027**.

[Calls for Labs](#)

JOKER Task 2 Codabench

[Benchmarks/Competitions](#)[Datasets](#)[liana87](#)

CLEF 2026 JOKER TASK 2: TRANSLATION OF PUNS FROM ENGLISH TO FRENCH

13 PARTICIPANTS

442 SUBMISSIONS

[Edit](#)[Participants](#)[Submissions](#)[Dumps](#)[Migrate](#)ORGANIZED BY: [Liana87](#)

CURRENT PHASE ENDS: Never

CURRENT SERVER TIME: 15 Juin 2026 à 17:40 UTC+1

Docker image: [codalab/codalab-legacy:py39](#)Secret url: https://www.codabench.org/competitions/16309/?secret_key=9ec14316-cc5b-4df5-b083-02d643919fd4



Maison
des
Sciences
de l'Homme
en Bretagne



Thank you !
Please join our track !

Website : <https://joker-project.com>⁶

E-mail : contact@joker-project.com

Twitter : https://twitter.com/joker_research

Google group : <https://groups.google.com/g/joker-project>

⁶This project has received a government grant managed by the National Research Agency under the program “*Investissements d’avenir*” integrated into France 2030, with the Reference ANR-19-GURE-0001.